ISSUE #2 · WEEK 44 · 25 OCT–1 NOV 2026

The Weekly Signal

Geopolitics, Switzerland, money, Bitcoin and AI, read from Mattia's newsletters, feeds and podcasts and checked against the open web. The week in five minutes is the core read; the full issue is about 30 minutes.

FACT reported by two outlets or primary data · OPINION a source's argument · CLAUDE Claude's own reading · SOURCE where it comes from · UNCONFIRMED single or anonymous source

IN THIS ISSUE

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The week in five minutes

1. **Talks and threats on Iran, in the same week.** Washington wrote to Tehran to restart truce talks and Iran sent a delegation to Doha, while Gulf officials say the Trump camp is warning of short, intense strikes from 4 November, the day after the midterms.

   Why it matters: Brent is still about $114, and the date of any strike now sets oil, inflation and rate expectations.

2. **The AI trade cracked on earnings.** Alphabet lost about $500 billion in a day, Intel fell more than 20% and the Nasdaq ended the week 2.0% lower, while Anthropic's IPO filing showed revenue up about fourteenfold.

   Why it matters: markets now pay only for AI spending that shows up in revenue.

3. **The Fed held, but two officials wanted a hike.** Rates stayed at 3.75–4.00% with two dissents for 25 bp more; the ECB held too, and Lagarde will leave in February.

   Why it matters: a December hike is now priced as likely, which weighed on gold.

4. **Israel's vote produced a stalemate.** Netanyahu's bloc has 53 of 120 seats and Eisenkot's 48; nobody reaches 61.

   Why it matters: a caretaker Netanyahu keeps his war powers over Iran during weeks of coalition talks.

5. **The largest crypto theft on record hit Binance.** About $6.3 billion was taken; investigators point to North Korea and Binance says it is covering customer losses. Bitcoin fell to about $76,000 and US ETFs lost about $200 million on the week.

   Why it matters: the case for self-custody, and for regulating custodians, both got stronger.

6. **Switzerland signed a better trade deal with China** and the SNB reported a CHF 44 billion nine-month profit, while the SMI rose 2.4% as money left US tech.

7. **Lula won a fourth term and Brazil's markets crashed.** The real had its worst day this century; prediction markets had given his challenger about 80%.

1 Geopolitics

Iran: a letter, a delegation and a deadline

WIDELY COVERED

FACT The week opened with the highest-level contact between Iran and its neighbours since the war began on 28 February: Saudi defence minister Khalid bin Salman, Pakistan's army chief Asim Munir and Türkiye's intelligence chief İbrahim Kalın met President Pezeshkian in Tehran on 26–27 October. The Houthis kept up the pressure on Riyadh: they claimed a strike on Ras Tanura, Saudi Arabia's largest refinery and export hub. On 29 October Vice President JD Vance wrote to Iran's top security official to restart truce talks, and Gulf states are pushing a deal to reopen Hormuz fully. Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi called the outreach a positive step, and an Iranian delegation travelled to Doha on Saturday after Qatari mediators had been in Tehran. At the same time, three Gulf officials say the Trump camp is warning of brief but intense strikes as early as 4 November; the Wall Street Journal had earlier reported US–Israeli planning for "short, intense" strikes after the midterms, with no final decision. October attacks on ships in and around Hormuz were the highest since the war began, according to The National. CLAUDE Talks and threats in the same week are one strategy, not a contradiction. The date is the tell: a strike after the vote removes the domestic cost of a fuel-price spike before the election, so Tehran has every reason to stall until Wednesday and see who controls Congress. Watch Brent: a rise before 4 November means the market believes the threat.

SOURCE Semafor Gulf: Mecca Pact officials in Tehran · Semafor Flagship: Fresh push to end Mideast war · Al Jazeera: Iran FM says US outreach a "positive step" · EA WorldView: Trump camp threatens attacks on November 4 · The National: Hormuz attacks in October highest since start of war · Doomberg: Tough Comp

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Israel: Netanyahu 53, Eisenkot 48, and no government

WIDELY COVERED

FACT Tuesday's election drew a record turnout of about 78%. With all votes counted Netanyahu's bloc has 53 of 120 seats, Eisenkot's 48 and the Arab parties a record 19, so no camp reaches the 61 needed. Both blocs avoid relying on the Arab parties. Until a government forms (it took 58 days in 2022), Netanyahu stays caretaker prime minister with full war powers. Trump endorsed him before the vote. OPINION Mearsheimer argues the result barely matters because Eisenkot and Netanyahu differ little on Iran or the Palestinians. Chatham House's Sanam Vakil told Semafor most Gulf capitals would have welcomed a Netanyahu defeat, and that Saudi normalisation stays out of reach if he stays. CLAUDE The arithmetic favours stalemate and possibly a fifth election in a few years' time. For the Iran file that means continuity: the man who started the war decides whether to join a new round of strikes, without needing a coalition to back him.

SOURCE Times of Israel: With all votes counted, Netanyahu's bloc has 53 seats · Al Jazeera: Israel election shows no overall majority · Semafor Gulf: Implications of Israeli elections · Mearsheimer: Does It Matter Who Is Israel's PM?

Ukraine: Washington trades fuel prices for a truce

WIDELY COVERED

FACT Finland's President Stubb and Norway's Prime Minister Støre held a 90-minute call with Putin, breaking Europe's taboo on direct contact; reactions in the EU were split. A local ceasefire in occupied Oleshky, brokered by the US, held for several days, while a Russian drone strike on Dnipro's train station killed at least 14 on Thursday. US-led talks are expected next month. UNCONFIRMED The Wall Street Journal reported that Kyiv paused strikes on Russian refineries at Washington's request to bring down fuel prices, and Reuters that the Pentagon asked Europeans to tone down warnings about Russia. CLAUDE Fuel prices, not the front line, now drive US policy on Russia. With Brent above $110 because of the Gulf, every Russian refinery Ukraine does not hit is worth something to the White House before the midterms. That gives Moscow leverage it did not win on the battlefield.

SOURCE Semafor Flagship: Norway, Finland reach out to Putin · Semafor Flagship: US pressures allies on Russia · International Intrigue, 27–29 Oct

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China: Xi's plenum is about loyalty, not growth

WIDELY COVERED

FACT The Communist Party's Fifth Plenum (26–29 October) expelled 33 senior officials and promoted the former head of military anti-graft work to the Politburo. The Central Military Commission is down to two members, one of them Xi. Beijing will send envoys to the Gulf and has reportedly pressed Tehran to rein in the Houthis. CLAUDE A military command reduced to Xi and one loyalist is a sign of distrust, not of readiness for war. The more immediate signal is economic: Beijing's interest in a calm Gulf is about oil supply, and it is the one outside power Tehran listens to.

SOURCE Semafor Flagship: Xi purges more party elite · Semafor China: Xi's succession in spotlight · Semafor Flagship: Beijing renews Gulf diplomacy push · International Intrigue: Party animal (29 Oct)

2 World tour

Europe

- FACT **France**'s economy unexpectedly shrank in the third quarter, and the third weekend of protests drew about 320,000 people (down from 550,000 on 17 October), with clashes in Paris and Lyon. The far right is favoured for April's presidential vote. France 24 · Semafor
- FACT **Spain**: a train crash near Toledo on 28 October killed 68, the second deadly crash on the line this year, weeks before a snap election. Semafor · International Intrigue
- FACT **Serbia**: Vučić conceded after the student-led list beat his party by 14 points on record turnout. Semafor · International Intrigue
- FACT **Netherlands**: the government will cut 25,000 civil-service jobs, over 15% of the total, using AI, to save about $3.9 billion a year by 2035. Semafor · International Intrigue

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Africa

- UNCONFIRMED Ebola cases in Congo passed 10,000 with a fatality rate near 50%, and the outbreak has reached Kenya and Nigeria; the Africa CDC head said "we are not winning". Semafor
- UNCONFIRMED Only about 22 leaders attended Russia's Africa summit in Moscow, against 43 in 2019. Semafor Africa

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Americas

- FACT **Brazil**: Lula won a fourth term with 51.8%. The real had its worst day this century, debt is above 82% of GDP and the deficit above 8%. His challenger Flávio Bolsonaro left for Miami and calls himself the "legitimate leader"; Trump called the result rigged. Semafor · International Intrigue
- FACT **Venezuela**: María Corina Machado is back from exile, and output has reached about 1.25 million barrels a day, up from 830,000 in December. Semafor · Doomberg
- OPINION **US midterms** on Tuesday: Democrats are expected to take the House; Nate Silver gives them a 76% chance of the Senate, The Economist's model 54%. Petrol is about 40% dearer than a year ago. Semafor Americana

3 Switzerland

A better deal with China, and a big SNB profit

FACT Economics minister and President Guy Parmelin signed the upgrade of the Swiss–China free trade agreement in Beijing on 30 October: China cuts tariffs on practically all Swiss goods, investment gets easier, and a panel of experts will settle disputes; Swiss farm concessions stay within existing WTO quotas. Parmelin said China still has "certain trade barriers". The SNB reported a nine-month profit of CHF 44.2 billion, driven by foreign-currency positions (+43.3 billion) and offset by bond losses; up to CHF 6 billion could be paid out to the Confederation and cantons. UBS earned $2.7 billion in the third quarter and plans to finish the Credit Suisse integration this year; the National Council debates the stricter capital rules in the winter session (30 November–18 December). CLAUDE The SNB's profit is mostly a paper gain from a weak franc earlier in the year, and the SNB itself warns October will be harder because the franc rose as a safe haven. The China deal is the more lasting news: it lands while the EU prepares new curbs on Chinese goods, which gives Swiss exporters an edge and Brussels a reason to watch.

SOURCE SRF: Parmelin: «China hat noch immer gewisse Handelshemmnisse» · SRF: SNB erzielt nach 9 Monaten hohen Milliardengewinn · SRF: UBS: 2.7 Milliarden Dollar Gewinn

Defence: a CHF 50 million fraud and a CHF 5 billion choice

FACT An investigation into Ruag found a former employee caused about CHF 50 million in damage and that a South African company had been set up to get around export rules; Defence Minister Martin Pfister said he was shocked by the "criminal energy" and wants a fundamental review of Ruag. Separately, the army prefers Israel's Barak MX over the Franco-Italian SAMP/T NG for its new medium-range air defence, at a cost of at least CHF 5 billion; politicians lean the other way, and the left and the SVP blocked a fast track. CLAUDE The timing hurts the government: the Ruag case lands four weeks before the 29 November vote on loosening war-material export rules, and it adds to the F-35 fixed-price row. Expect the No side to use it.

SOURCE SRF: Ruag-Betrugsfall · SRF: Pfister: «Mich schockiert die kriminelle Energie» · SRF: Das Militär würde in Israel kaufen

Also in Switzerland

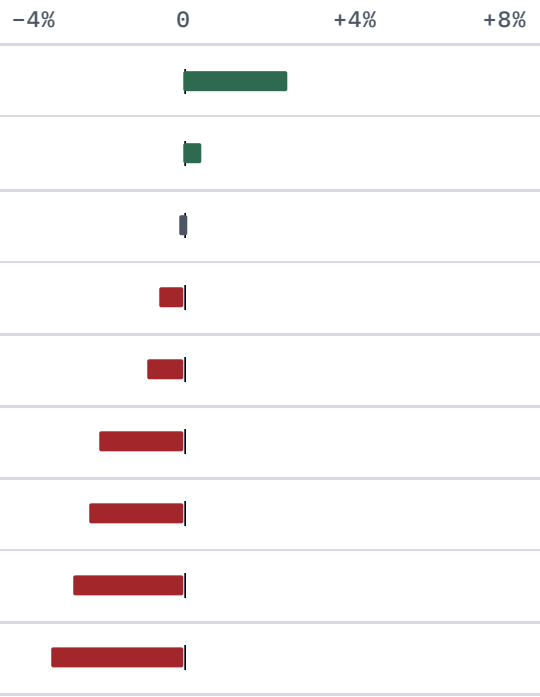
- FACT **Bundesrat**: eight SVP candidates are in hearings for Parmelin's seat; the party's selection committee proposes by 13 November, the group decides on 20 November and parliament elects on 9 December. Green leader Lisa Mazzone has "big problems" with Céline Amaudruz, the only woman in the field. SRF · cash.ch
- FACT Foreign Minister Ignazio Cassis visited Pyongyang, where the Swiss embassy reopened; Kim Jong Un did not meet him. Kyiv says parts from 11 Swiss firms turned up in new Russian weapons. SRF · SRF

4 Money & Macro

WEEKLY MOVES, FRI 23 OCT → FRI 30 OCT

Closing prices; Bitcoin is Sunday 1 Nov against Sunday 25 Oct.

ASSET	LEVEL	WEEK
SMI	14,811	+2.4%
USD/CHF	0.823	+0.4%
EUR/CHF	0.920	≈ 0%
S&P 500	7,580	−0.6%
Dow Jones	51,770	−0.9%
Nasdaq	25,437	−2.0%
Brent crude	$114.1	−2.2%
Bitcoin	$77,970	−2.6%
Gold	$3,884	−3.1%
US 10-year	4.93%	−6 bp on the week; 5.36% peak on 7 Oct



Central banks: the Fed holds, hawks dissent, Lagarde leaves

WIDELY COVERED

FACT The Federal Reserve kept its range at 3.75–4.00% on 28 October, as expected before the election, but Governor Lisa Cook and Cleveland Fed President Beth Hammack dissented in favour of a 25 bp hike. The statement upgraded the economy from "solid" to "strong". Futures now price a December hike at about 85%, according to Rio Times. The ECB held its deposit rate at 2.5% on 29 October; Christine Lagarde announced she will step down on 7 February 2027, about nine months early, so a successor can be named before France votes in April. UNCONFIRMED Reuters, via Semafor, says Lagarde is expected to lead the World Economic Forum in Geneva. OPINION Nik Bhatia (The Bitcoin Layer) says October's fall in Treasury yields from a two-decade high triggered a buy signal on his liquidity indicator, and that "we are approaching the end of a credit cycle". CLAUDE Two dissents for a hike, with oil above $110, are a warning that the Fed's next move is up, not down. That is the main reason gold, which pays no interest, fell this week while war risk stayed high.

SOURCE Wolf Street: Fed Holds Rates, but with 2 Dissenters · Mises: The FOMC Statement: No Rate Hike · SRF: Lagarde belässt Leitzins · Mises: Federal Debt Hits 100% of GDP · Rio Times: Silver drops 5%, gold 3% · The Bitcoin Layer: Understanding the 4 Drivers of Bitcoin's Price

The AI repricing: Alphabet, Intel and a $95 billion share sale

WIDELY COVERED

FACT Alphabet fell as much as 13% on Thursday, wiping out more than $500 billion, its worst day ever, after search revenue growth slowed and free cash flow turned negative from record AI spending. Amazon's results did not reassure, and Intel dropped more than 20% after warning that AI-driven memory shortages will cut PC sales by about 10% next year. The Nasdaq fell 2.9% on Friday. Meta is selling about $95 billion of stock, and hyperscalers are on course to spend about $800 billion this year. Swiss defensives went the other way: the SMI gained 2.4% on the week. OPINION Michael Burry, writing on Anthropic's filing, says the key issue is "the degree of risk in the system", pointing to circular revenue between AI labs and their cloud partners. CLAUDE The market is no longer paying for AI spending as such, only for spending that shows up in revenue. Companies funding the build-out with debt and new shares are being sorted from those funding it from profits, and Swiss pharma and food stocks are where money waits meanwhile.

SOURCE Semafor: Alphabet's worst day · Semafor: Amazon and Intel disappoint · Semafor: AI financing · Cassandra Unchained: Short Thoughts: Anthropic's S-1 · market data: Yahoo Finance closes

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Gold: down 3% in a week of war and debt

FACT Gold fell 3.1% on the week to about $3,884 an ounce, including a 3.7% drop on Friday, and silver fell more than 5% that day. Both are far below their January highs. The drivers were the Fed's hawkish dissents, a 10-year yield near 5% and a firmer dollar. In francs, gold ended at about CHF 3,198 an ounce. OPINION The In Gold We Trust chartbook (29 October) calls 2026 "a year of extremes", with silver more than 50% and gold about 25% below their highs, and argues gold is being "remonetised": central banks buying and repatriating reserves, private and digital demand ("Tether now holds more gold than many central banks"), and, in future, revalued official reserves. It argues every investor group is underweight. CLAUDE The long case for gold is about debt and trust; the short-term price is about real interest rates. This week the second won. A Fed that hikes into an oil shock is the scenario where gold can fall even while the reasons to hold it grow.

SOURCE Rio Times: Silver Drops 5%, Gold 3% as Rout Accelerates · Yahoo Finance: Gold slips below $4,000 · In Gold We Trust: Chartbook, Back to the Monetary Future

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The Austrian reading CLAUDE

Definition. Financial repression is any policy that moves wealth from savers to the state without a vote on a tax: rates held below inflation, forced bond holdings, capital controls or a one-off deposit levy.

1. **The debt.** US federal debt has passed 100% of GDP, France's economy is shrinking with a large deficit, and Brazil's debt is above 82% of GDP.
2. **The squeeze.** Interest costs rise as rates rise; the Fed is now leaning towards a hike. Governments then face a choice between spending cuts, default, or quietly eroding what they owe.
3. **The tools.** The Daily Bitcoiner lists the history: Italy taxed 0.6% of all deposits in 1992, on balances held two days before the decree; Cyprus turned 47.5% of uninsured deposits into bank shares in 2013. The levy always looks backwards.
4. **The lesson.** Mises tied sound money to freedom: a money the state cannot print or freeze limits what it can take. In Austrian terms, the decision about exposure has to be made before the announcement, not after.

Counter-argument. Repression is a choice, not a law of nature. The US and UK paid down large post-war debts mostly through growth, and Switzerland's debt brake shows that rules can hold. Deposit levies remain rare and mostly hit countries in acute crisis; treating every debt headline as a prelude to confiscation can cost more in missed returns than it protects.

SOURCE The Daily Bitcoiner: Moving Your Money After the Announcement Won't Help · The Daily Bitcoiner: Why Your Friends Still Don't Get Bitcoin · Der Bitcoin Podcast: Bitwise report

5 Bitcoin

Price and flows: a $76,000 low after the Binance hack

FACT Bitcoin traded between about $81,900 on Thursday and $76,200 on Friday and stood near $77,970 on Sunday, 2.6% lower on the week and about 38% below its October 2025 high near $126,000. US spot Bitcoin ETFs took in about $441 million from Monday to Thursday, then lost $643 million on Friday after the hack, for a net outflow of about $203 million on the week. OPINION Checkonchain's James Check says a "chorus" of respected analysts expects a flash risk-off event, and that the value lies in looking through it. Sentiment analyst Michael Sullivan reads the "Binance broke Bitcoin" headlines as a crowd overreaction and calls this a "disbelief rally". CLAUDE A weekly outflow of $200 million is small against the ETFs' size, and four days of inflows came first. The more telling number is the gap between price and the cost basis of big buyers: Strategy's average is about $75,400, so the market is testing the level where the largest treasury company is roughly at break-even.

SOURCE Bitcoin.com News: Bitcoin ETFs lose $643M after Binance hack · The Cryptonomist: Bitcoin price drop deepens · Checkonchain: Flash Update: Halloween Headlines · Bitcoin Sentiment Weekly: How Much Upside Does Bitcoin Still Have? · price data: CoinGecko, Yahoo Finance

Binance: $6.3 billion gone in 20 minutes

WIDELY COVERED

FACT Attackers took about $6.3 billion from Binance wallets on ten blockchains, most of it within 20 minutes, the largest crypto theft on record; SRF reports the entry point was an engineer's compromised laptop. Blockchain analysts TRM Labs said with high confidence that North Korea's TraderTraitor unit was behind it, the group the FBI tied to last year's $1.5 billion Bybit theft. About half was frozen with the help of Tether, Circle and Ripple; Binance says it has replaced about 90% by buying the assets back, will cover all customer losses, and planned to restart withdrawals on Sunday. CLAUDE Coins in self-custody were untouched; coins on the exchange depended on Binance's balance sheet. That Binance could cover a $6 billion hole is reassuring this time, but the next attack may hit a smaller exchange that cannot.

SOURCE CBS News: $6.3 billion Binance hack was likely work of North Korea · TechCrunch: North Korean hackers blamed · SRF: Wie konnten die Täter den Binance-Raub durchführen? · SRF: Binance ersetzt 90 Prozent

Treasury companies: Strategy stops buying and starts saving

FACT Strategy bought no Bitcoin from 19 to 25 October, according to its filing, and holds 848,517 BTC at an average of about $75,400; it used the week to buy back $205 million of its STRC preferred shares and holds a USD reserve of about $4.8 billion. UNCONFIRMED On the third-quarter call (30 October), as summarised by Bitcoin Treasuries, Strategy reported a record fair-value gain, said it added only about 1,700 BTC net in the quarter, and said its CFO steps down on 5 November; CEO Phong Le said the main way to buy Bitcoin is now by issuing "digital credit", with new common shares only if the premium to its Bitcoin expands. OPINION On The Big Bitcoin Show, British HODL and Grain of Salt argue treasury companies should build cash, not Bitcoin, in the next bull run. CLAUDE This is a real change: the largest buyer of the last two years is now managing its own debt load instead of adding coins. Less forced buying means less support on the way up, but also less forced selling risk on the way down.

SOURCE CoinGabbar: Strategy 8-K of 26 October · Bitcoin Treasuries: STRC Closed at $99.99. Is Strategy Done Diluting MSTR?

The argument of the week: ETF or your own keys?

OPINION Nik Bhatia (The Bitcoin Layer) argues that after the Binance hack and earlier breaches at Coldcard and Ledger, ETFs are a legitimate choice for many people, especially near retirement: low fees, insured multisig cold storage, SEC rules, and shares that can be pledged as collateral. The Daily Bitcoiner (Swan) argues the opposite lesson from history: confiscations and levies are retroactive, and only self-custody removes the issuer and the redemption step. CLAUDE Both are right about different risks. An ETF protects against your own mistakes and a hacked exchange; it does not protect against the state, because a fund share is a claim inside the banking system. Self-custody protects against the state and the exchange but puts all operational risk on you. Splitting by purpose, long-term savings in your own keys and trading money in regulated funds, answers both. In Switzerland the first retail spot fund, BBIT, approved by FINMA on 20 October, is due to list on SIX this month.

SOURCE The Bitcoin Layer: 5 Reasons Why Bitcoin ETFs Just Make Sense · The Daily Bitcoiner: Moving Your Money After the Announcement Won't Help · CryptoDaily: FINMA approves BBIT

What to watch

- Binance withdrawals restarting, and whether frozen funds come back.
- Strategy's Monday filing: a second week without purchases would confirm the new policy.
- BBIT's SIX listing date. OPINION Bitwise's new report sees $1.6 million per Bitcoin by 2036 in its base case; Der Bitcoin Podcast's host notes Bitwise has a strong interest in that number.

6 AI

Anthropic's prospectus, and a crowded frontier

WIDELY COVERED

FACT Anthropic filed for a Nasdaq listing under the ticker ANT on 26 October. The prospectus shows first-half revenue of $16.3 billion, about 14 times a year earlier, and a net loss of $80.7 billion, of which $72.4 billion are changes in the fair value of instruments; the company says Claude wrote over 90% of its code in September, and the seven co-founders keep control through a golden share. Google's Gemini 4 Carbon tops the Artificial Analysis index but is limited to cyber defenders for now; OpenAI's GPT-6.1 Terra costs half its predecessor; China's Kimi K3.1 Pro ranks fourth, with open weights promised by 4 November. UNCONFIRMED The listing is reportedly aimed at the week of 16 November. CLAUDE The filing's most important line for users is not the revenue but the risk section, which warns that some AI work could become hard for any human group to understand and control.

SOURCE Entrepreneur: Anthropic Files for Nasdaq IPO · The Rundown AI: The AI bubble meets Anthropic's real numbers · Semafor Technology: Anthropic's S-1 · The Rundown AI: Gemini 4 Carbon tops the charts · Simon Willison: GPT-6.1 Terra

PRACTICAL INSIGHT 1 · ARCHITECTURE

From floor plan to a 3D room viewer in an hour

The Rundown featured Michael Saif, who built a small tool with Claude Cowork in under an hour: upload a floor plan, pick a room, rotate a 3D view, change finishes by prompt, save variants and export images. The same approach works for early client conversations about a renovation, without opening a BIM model:

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"Build a single-page tool: I upload a floor plan (PDF or PNG) and type the
room dimensions. Show the room in 3D that I can rotate. Let me change
floor, wall and ceiling finishes by typing, save each variant with a name,
and export a PNG of the current view. Keep all measurements editable."
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Good for options in a client meeting, not for construction drawings: it guesses heights and openings unless you give them.

PRACTICAL INSIGHT 2

Fix the camera before you compare options

A Rundown guide used GPT-6.1 Terra with computer use to drive Blender: exact dimensions, fixed camera and lights, colour variants and a saved scene for later changes. For massing and material studies, lock camera, light and sun first, then change one variable at a time so renders compare honestly.

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"Keep the camera, lens, lights and sun angle exactly as they are. Make
three variants that change only the facade material: fibre cement, larch
and render. Name the files by material."
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7 The bigger picture

Empires on credit CLAUDE

Great powers. This week showed a United States that sets the terms of two wars at once, Iran and Ukraine, but increasingly by the logic of its own fuel prices and election calendar. Allies are asked to quieten down, Kyiv to stop hitting refineries, the Gulf to broker. Russia's Africa summit drew half the leaders of 2019; China works the Gulf quietly. Power is shifting less to a rival than towards a world where each region makes its own deals.

Technology. The AI build-out is now the largest private investment programme in the world, financed more and more with debt and new shares. History suggests such booms (railways in the 1840s, telecoms in the late 1990s) leave useful infrastructure and ruined investors at the same time.

Society. Students drove the upsets in Serbia and the protests in France: a young generation that expects less from the state and is getting less.

Economy. Public debt above 100% of GDP in the US, a shrinking France, a crashing Brazil: governments have borrowed against the future and now face rising rates. The historical pattern is that such debts are rarely repaid in full; they are inflated away, restructured or repressed.

What to learn. Keep savings where neither a hacked exchange nor a stressed government can easily reach them, value companies by cash rather than stories, and expect Switzerland's stability to stay in demand, which keeps the franc strong.

8 Contradictions, blind spots & additions

Correction: the Binance number

Friday's Daily put the theft at about $5.5 billion, the first figure reported by Checkonchain and Semafor. Later reports from TRM Labs, CBS and TechCrunch put it at about $6.3 billion. This issue uses the later figure. CLAUDE

Hawkish Fed, falling yields?

Two dissents for a hike, yet the 10-year fell 6 bp on the week. The bond market is pricing a slower economy (France, PC sales, Gulf contraction) more than the Fed's next step. CLAUDE

Blind spot: Gulf economies

Coverage focuses on oil prices, but the IMF expects Gulf economies to shrink 4.8% this year. High prices do not help producers who cannot ship. CLAUDE

9 Watch next week

Tue 3 Nov	US midterms · Reserve Bank of Australia decision (hold or hike to 4.85%)
Wed 4 Nov	Earliest date Gulf officials cite for possible US strikes on Iran · Kimi K3.1 Pro open weights due
Thu 5 Nov	Bank of England decision and Monetary Policy Report · Strategy's CFO leaves
Fri 6 Nov	US jobs report for October
This month	BBIT listing on SIX · SVP selection committee proposal by 13 Nov · Anthropic listing, reportedly week of 16 Nov · Swiss votes on 29 Nov (war-material exports, VAT for AHV)

10 Worth listening

GRASSL & MATEI · #244 · 29 OCT · DE

Superwahlwoche: Israel im Chaos

The week of elections in Israel, Brazil and Serbia in one conversation; the follow-up to #243 before the Israeli vote.

LEX FRIDMAN · #503 · 26 OCT

AI Crisis in Math: Navier-Stokes, Riemann Hypothesis & Complexity Theory

What happens to mathematics when AI starts proving and disproving results, the background to this week's AI claims.

WAS BITCOIN BRINGT · 29 OCT · DE

«Dann ist es gelaufen!» Saylor & Fink machen Bitcoin zur Leitwährung with Peter Kotauczek

An Austrian-leaning case for Bitcoin as reserve money, useful next to this week's ETF-versus-keys debate.

Also good: All-In on Anthropic's S-1 and Google's $500 billion day (30 Oct, VC perspective) · Bitcoin Standard Podcast 349, "The Gold Standard" (27 Oct) · Was Bitcoin bringt with Sebastian Markowsky (27 Oct, DE) · Tucker Carlson with Jeffrey Sachs on Netanyahu (29 Oct, opinion show).

11 Worth reading in full

Tough Comp

Doomberg · why an air campaign against Iran is unlikely to end the war, read through Russia's experience in Ukraine

STRC Closed at $99.99. Is Strategy Done Diluting MSTR?

Bitcoin Treasuries · the Q3 call and the cash-versus-coins debate among treasury companies

Interventionism Created Spain's Housing Crisis

Daniel Lacalle, Mises · rent rules, permits and land policy behind Spain's shortage; relevant to anyone who builds

Source health

CONTRIBUTED

Semafor (Flagship, Gulf, China, Africa, Energy, Americana, Technology) · International Intrigue · The Bitcoin Layer (4) · Doomberg (2) · Checkonchain (3) · Bitcoin Sentiment Weekly (3) · The Daily Bitcoiner (2) · Bitcoin Treasuries · BlingBling (2) · Cassandra Unchained (2) · Leon Wankum · BitBox (2) · Rundown AI (5) · Mearsheimer (2) · In Gold We Trust (forwarded) · Der Bitcoin Podcast newsletter (new) · Mises Wire · Simon Willison · Import AI · Swiss web (SRF, cash.ch, bluewin) · podcasts: Grassl & Matei, Was Bitcoin bringt (2), Bitcoin Standard, All-In (2), Lex Fridman, Tucker, Part of the Problem, Modern Wisdom

NOTHING NEW THIS WEEK

One Useful Thing (20 Oct) · McNair (13 Oct) · Hersh (14 Oct) · Arthur Hayes (11 Aug) · Radio Rothbard (23 Oct) · Sound Money Bitcoin (20 Oct) · Martyr Made (28 Sep) · Peter McCormack (18 Oct) · welcome mails only: Economic Historian, Fix the money, Breedlove, Jesse Myers, Bitcoin Katie, Simply Bitcoin Unfiltered, Greenwald, Martyr Made, McCormack, Lyn Alden (new)

FAILED OR NEEDS ACTION

Silent two weeks or more: Jimmy Song (last new issue 21 Sep; this week's mail was a stale September issue) · Incrementum (last issue 6 Oct; confirmation from 24 Oct still unclicked?) · Not reaching this inbox directly: Informationist, Dalio, Scholarium, Luke Gromen, Relai, Simply Bitcoin, In Gold We Trust, Bitcoin News Weekly; they may still be subscribed with another address · Friedrich & Partner: promotional mails only · Feed leads: Der Bitcoin-Podcast (Florian Bruce) may have an Anchor feed via podcasters.spotify.com/pod/show/florian--friedemann (unverified); Human Action Podcast page at mises.org/podcasts/human-action-podcast

Sources

1. Semafor Gulf: Mecca Pact officials in Tehran
2. Semafor Flagship: Fresh push to end Mideast war
3. Al Jazeera: Iran FM says US outreach a "positive step"
4. EA WorldView: Trump camp threatens attacks on November 4
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Written by Claude from Mattia's newsletters, feeds and podcasts, checked against the open web.